

WOLVERINE

The best there is at what he does—but what he does isn't pretty!

WOLVERINE

FACTFILE
REAL NAME
James Howlett; often goes by Logan
OCCUPATION
Adventurer
BASE
The Xavier Academy, Salem Center, Westchester, New York

HEIGHT 5 ft 3 in
WEIGHT 195 lbs
EYES Brown
HAIR Black

FIRST APPEARANCE
Incredible Hulk #180
(October 1974)

POWERS

Wolverine possesses a "healing factor" that allows him to recover from almost any injury in seconds. His skeleton has been laced with the unbreakable metal Adamantium, which makes his bones unshatterable. Wolverine also possesses three foot-long adamantium claws that retract from either hand, capable of slicing through almost any substance known to man.

ALLIES/FOES

ALLIES X-Men, New Avengers, Nick Fury
FOES Sabretooth, Omega Red, Silver Samurai

ISSUE #1

After a successful limited series in 1982, Wolverine was awarded his own ongoing title in November, 1988, a series devoted to his solo adventures apart from his fellow X-Men. The title has been published ever since.



Childhood traumas were repressed by a mutant healing factor.

Born at the turn of the century, James Howlett, the man who would one day become known and feared as Wolverine, was a sickly child. But he was also born a mutant, gifted with the remarkable ability to heal virtually instantaneously from almost any wound. He also had razor-sharp claws made of bone, a fact he first became aware of when, during a domestic dispute, he accidentally unsheathed his claws for the first time, killing his assailant.

THE WANDERER

Forced by his nature to leave behind the pampered world in which he grew up, Howlett began a life of wandering, moving from place to place. His own healing factor acted upon his mind to suppress the traumatic memories of his childhood, leaving him a man without a past. Over the years, he took on a succession of menial jobs, building up his strength and stamina, and losing himself in the repetitiveness of simple work. By this point, he had adopted the name Logan, after the groundskeeper at the Howlett estate, who might have been his real father. But both the man and the estate were long lost among the indistinct memories buried deep within his mind.

Logan lived the life of a drifter, moving from one adventure to another, learning all there was to know about fighting along the way. He fought in both world wars, spent time in Japan, and made his home-away-from-home in the tiny city of Madripoor, a haven for smugglers and pirates. His miraculous healing factor prolonged his natural lifespan, making him appear far younger than he truly was. For a time, he operated as a secret agent for the Canadian government, a vocation and association that would come to have dire ramifications.

A secret project of the Canadian government was attempting to create a super-soldier along the lines of the famous CAPTAIN AMERICA.

With an unbreakable adamantium skeleton, retractable razor-sharp claws, and a healing factor that also prolongs his lifespan, Wolverine is an almost unbeatable opponent.



A haunted figure, Logan spent much of his youth wandering the world.

ESSENTIAL STORYLINES

• Origin #1–6

The secret beginnings of Wolverine are revealed for the first time.

• Wolverine Limited Series #1–4

Wolverine must wage a war of honor in Japan to protect the woman he loves, and to prove that he is more man than beast.

• Wolverine Vol. 2 #21–34

Brainwashed by HYDRA, Wolverine is sent to kill the greatest Super Heroes in the Marvel Universe.



Selected as a subject for enhancement due to his incredible healing factor, the mysterious forces behind the Canadian Weapon X project laced Logan's skeleton and claws with the unbreakable metal, adamantium.

Kidnapped and used as a guinea pig, Logan, now referred to as Weapon X, was subjected to unimaginable tortures as his captors attempted to mold him to their liking. Realizing that Logan's healing factor would allow him to survive procedures which would kill any ordinary man, the scientists of the Weapon X project laced his skeleton with a nearly-unbreakable metal alloy known as adamantium. They also attempted to control his mind by brainwashing, which only served to scramble Logan's memories even further.

But eventually they could contain Logan no longer. Reduced to a bestial state, Logan broke free, annihilated the Weapon X project and all of its personnel, and fled into the Canadian wilderness. He lived there many years, hunting game to survive. A chance meeting with James MacDonald Hudson and his wife Heather put Logan on

As a result of the reality-altering powers of the Scarlet Witch, Wolverine gained possession of all of his lost memories. This knowledge remained with Logan even after the world returned to its normal state.

the road back to humanity. They took the beast-man into their home, and nursed him back to health. Hudson was a scientist working for the Canadian government, where he had developed a battlesuit that he hoped would make him a hero on a par with the newly-revealed American group, the FANTASTIC FOUR.

A NEW NAME

Attempting to put together an equivalent team of Canadian Super Heroes, Hudson brought Logan into Alpha Flight, where he was given the codename Wolverine. Hudson had intended Wolverine to be the leader of this new strike force, but all that changed when a man in a wheelchair entered the scene: Professor Charles Xavier (PROFESSOR X), the mutant telepath who had founded the clandestine team of mutant heroes the X-MEN.

Recognizing Wolverine's mutant nature, Professor X offered him a place among others of his kind. Wolverine accepted Xavier's offer and went to live in his School for Gifted Youngsters, which doubled as the X-Men's headquarters. While his savage nature

initially alienated his fellow mutants, Wolverine found friendship among them, and came to be one of the strongest believers in Professor X's dream of co-existence between mutants and normal humans—though this belief was tinged with a healthy cynicism.

In addition to his duties as an X-Man, Wolverine joined the new AVENGERS. He continued to work with the underground Avengers who formed the core of CAPTAIN AMERICA's resistance during the Civil War (see pp 85–5). He helped restore reality after the SCARLET WITCH had a breakdown and

altered everything, and when most things turned back to normal on M-Day, he not only retained his powers but regained all of his lost memories, too.

Since then, Wolverine discovered that the baby he'd been about to have with his murdered wife Itsu had survived and was now a killer called DAKEN. Wolverine has since dedicated himself to saving his son from ROMULUS, the mysterious, manipulative figure behind Itsu's death, who apparently erased much of Wolverine's memories as well. **TB, MF**



Wolverine leaped at the chance to join Professor Charles Xavier's mutant team of X-Men.

